Blue

Calm · expression · depth

Blue can be open like a summer sky, deep like the sea and strict like a buttoned uniform jacket. One time you find in it **room to take a breath**, another time it seems too cold and distant.

This page does not tell you what blue means. **It shows it to you from several sides**. How it is mixed, how you paint with it, where its strength comes from, how it is read in different cultures and **what it can awaken in us**.

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How to mix the colour and its shades

In an ordinary painting set blue is one of the basic colours. The easiest start is a blue from a tube and the search for its shades. From yellow and red alone you will not get a pure blue. The proportions are only approximate and every brand behaves a little differently, so **try them out** on paper first.

What to prepare

- **Ultramarine blue** — *The starting blue for mixes towards violet.*
- **Cyan** — *Cool, light, airy.*
- **Burnt umber** — *Mutes and deepens.*
- **Violet** — *For ink-like and deeper blues.*
- **White** — *Lightens it and reveals the tint of the dark colour.*
- **Phthalo blue (green shade)** — *For azure and blue-green tones; it stains very strongly.*
- **Magenta** — *By the tip, when you want to push blue towards violet.*
- **Phthalo green** — *For petrol and sea mixes.*
- **Orange** — *The opposite of blue on the colour wheel; it mutes it.*

Can blue be made from two colours after all?

Yes, when working with cyan and magenta **you can** mix blue to blue-violet tones. It depends on the actual pigments, their strength and the proportion. Such a mix is not automatically the same as an ultramarine or cobalt from a tube, it tends to be slightly different. **Try** it as an experiment, not as a substitute.

How to recognise it without technical names

On the tube look for the marking PB (Pigment Blue) and a number. It tells you which pigment it is, even when the name differs. For example PB29 is ultramarine, PB15 phthalo blue and PB28 cobalt. A ready-made blue **you can** buy from a tube, but you can also shift it wherever you need.

Ultramarine suits as a starting blue for mixes towards violet. A phthalo blue with a green tint works well towards azure and blue-green tones and can stain very strongly. First **try** one small pile and only then add more.

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What the additions do



White

Lightens and pushes towards sky and pastel. Add it little by little.





Cyan

Refreshes, lifts towards the sky and towards turquoise.





Violet

Deepens towards ink and evening blue.





Phthalo green

Leads to petrol and sea. A strong pigment, add it carefully.





Burnt umber

Mutes and deepens. Denim, smoky. You easily add too much of it.





Orange

The opposite of blue. It mutes it; a bigger dose pulls it towards grey-brown.



Ten blues to try

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Ten blues to try – continued

A part means an equally sized dose of paint. A drop, a pinch or a pile. Take the proportions as a starting point for trying. With a strong phthalo blue much less may be enough. Try small mixes and write down the names of the tubes. Samples show an approximate impression, on paper they turn out differently.

Sky



4 parts white + about 1 part ultramarine. Add the blue into the white. When the tint is too violet, ***try*** *a dot of cyan.*

Lavender blue



3 parts white + 1 part ultramarine + a trace of magenta. If you want to stay with blue, add the magenta only by the tip.

Smoky blue



3 parts white + 1 part ultramarine + a small dot of burnt umber. First mix a light blue and only then mute it carefully.

Petrol



2 parts phthalo blue + gradually up to 1 part phthalo green. Both colours can be strong. A little white will show their tint.

Turquoise



1 part blue + 1 part green + a little white. Fresh, sea-like, a bit playful. The proportion is from the original card.

Cornflower



2 parts white + 1 part ultramarine; a dot of magenta if needed. **Try** *the magenta first in a small part of the mix.*

Denim



2 parts ultramarine + 1 part white + a tiny bit of burnt umber. The brown mix mutes; it is easy to add too much.

Navy



3 parts ultramarine; burnt umber little by little. Judge the darkness also in a thin layer on white paper.

Ink



3 parts ultramarine + up to 1 part violet; possibly a trace of umber. Violet deepens it, umber mutes. Add each separately.

Midnight



roughly 10 parts ultramarine + 1 part burnt umber or a drop of red. Deep, ***quiet****, mysterious. A pure black would rather dirty it. The proportion is my approximate suggestion.*

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When blue does not fit

Too green? **Try** a trace of magenta in a separate small dose. Too violet? **Try** cyan. Too garish? Mute with a small amount of a suitable orange or brown. Too dark? White will lighten it and make it more pastel. Saturate it only at the end.

With transparent watercolour lightness is also made by paper showing through. White from a tube changes the character of the mix. Let samples dry; wet and dry paint may not look the same.

When you mix more than three colours in one mix, it often turns to mud. That happens to every one of us.

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Rainbow – the chakra system

In the usual order of seven colours blue stands between green and indigo. In the rainbow map of the chakras it is the fifth and belongs to the throat chakra. **You can** imagine it as a place for **your own voice**, honest expression and listening.

The whole rainbow as a map of questions

Red · root



Safety, support, presence. Ask yourself. Do I have something to lean on? What gives me a sense of safety right now?

Yellow · solar plexus



Self-worth, will. Ask yourself. What do I want? Where do I need to stand up for myself?

Blue · throat



Voice, expression, listening. Ask yourself. What do I need to say? What do I no longer want to keep swallowing?

Violet · crown



Meaning, transcendence, connection. Ask yourself. What gives me meaning? What do I feel connected to?

Orange · sacral



Experiencing, pleasure, creating. Ask yourself. What does me good? Where do I allow myself joy?

Green · heart



Closeness, relationships. Ask yourself. How am I with myself? Whom do I let close?

Indigo · third eye



Inner vision, intuition. Ask yourself. What is beginning to dawn on me?

Chakra. Vishuddha, the throat chakra

The chakras come from the Indian yogic and tantric tradition. The throat chakra is called Vishuddha (from Sanskrit “purified” or “pure”). It sits in the throat area and the element ether (space), the seed syllable HAM and a lotus with sixteen petals belong to it. Blue is linked with it mainly in today's version. In some traditional descriptions other shades are given too, for example a smoky violet.

Its theme is communication, expression and truthfulness. For women this often turns into questions. Shall I say what I feel, or keep it to myself? Does anyone hear me, and do I hear myself?

When it is open. You say what you need and you can also listen. Your voice supports you, **you do not have to** apologise for speaking. You can also be silent when it is appropriate.

When it is closed. The tradition describes difficulty expressing yourself, **fear** of other people's reaction, a held-back word or, on the contrary, talking without end and without real contact. Closed does not mean bad. It is only a signal that the words in you lack a way out.

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How to add blue when you lack your own voice

A colour will not give you your voice back, but it can be a small reminder and invitation. Here are the forms in which **you can** let it into your life.

- **Wear it**
  A blue scarf, shawl or necklace near the throat. The throat is in the tradition the place of the voice and the colour will remind you of it.
- **Put it in your home**
  A blue mug, cushion or picture of the sea or sky in a place you look at every day.
- **Take it with you**
  A blue pebble, hair tie or ribbon in your pocket. Something you can touch when words will not come.
- **Take the sky and water**
  A few minutes by a window with a view of the sky, a walk by a river, a blue glass on the table.
- **Paint it**
  Wide blue stripes or circles at the top of the paper, with no goal and no judging.
- **Say it aloud**
  A blue mug in your hand and one sentence you have not said for a long time. Even just to a mirror or in your phone notes.

How to supplement blue when you talk too much

When words flow but nobody is really listening to you (and neither are you), you do not need more blue, but something that will **calm** and ground you.

- **Add green**
  Calm from trees and nature. Green in the flat or a walk in the forest helps you slow down and listen.
- **Add brown**
  Support and stability. Wood, natural materials, a feeling of earth under your feet.
- **Take away rich blue**
  Swap dark, cold shades for lighter and warmer ones until you feel warmer again.
- **Add orange**
  A warm counterpart and a spark. Terracotta, amber, a candle.

Ask yourself

"What would I need to say aloud today?"

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When it is said “closed”. What to imagine by it

Perhaps you repeatedly say “I do not mind” even though you have your own wish. Before an important sentence you withdraw, rather agree or first defend everything at length. In the language of the chakras such an experience can be described as blocked expression. By itself, however, it proves neither the state of a chakra nor an illness.

Blue on the body. Take a piece of jewellery, a shirt or underwear in a shade in which you feel good. Give it the meaning “my wishes have a place too”. In a concrete situation a single sentence may then be enough: “Today I would rather stay at home.” **You do not have to** force yourself into a big conversation.

When you talk over yourself and over others

In some readings the image of an “overactive” chakra is used. Interrupting, defending every little thing or **fear** of silence. Take it as a chance to notice a habit, not as a label. A blue bracelet can recall the space between sentences. Once you notice it, let the other person finish the thought. Then answer. The aim is not to talk less at any price, but to give room to yourself and to the other.

When the words are not there yet

A blue notebook can be a private place without an audience. Write what you would say if you did not have to defend yourself. **You do not have to** send it to anyone. If you do not want to write, **you can** stay with an image, a colour or silence. Not everything needs to be said immediately. If it feels pleasant to hum quietly, **try** an ordinary sound without performing and without controlling the breath. If it is uncomfortable, stop. It is not a test of the right vibration or a method of treating the throat.

Why blue, and which shade?

In this contemporary map blue is a symbol of expression and room for the voice. We draw the meaning from the tradition; the pigment itself has no proven ability to unblock a chakra. A soft sky blue may seem welcoming to you, a rich blue decisive and a dark one intimate. Take them as possibilities for your own experience. If a scarf round your neck feels tight or the colour is **unpleasant** to you, **you do not have to** have it at your throat. The same personal meaning can be carried by a ring or a private detail of underwear.

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How to tell that this work gives you something

In everyday life **you may** notice that you can voice a small wish without apologising, more easily let someone finish speaking or allow yourself to be silent. There is no need to check whether the chakra is already “open”. What matters is your experience, not meeting a spiritual doctrine.

Throat and health. Hoarseness, **pain** or difficulty swallowing should not be judged by a chakra. Persistent problems belong with a doctor. The examples with blue are prompts for self-knowledge and expression, not treatment.

Picture it with an example

You have on the tip of your tongue a sentence you have been putting off for a week. Green may ask how you are with yourself while doing it. Yellow, what you want. And blue. Shall I say it aloud? Blue does not stand here as a verdict, more as a calm question that **you can** answer at your own pace.

Next to blue other colours can feel calmer. Yellow makes it glow, white widens it and orange warms it. **These are possibilities of a personal reading**, not effects prescribed by a combination of colours.

How to use this map

It is a way of sorting out the themes you are living through. Do you add blue because you miss words and calm to say what you need? Or do you take it away because it is already cold around you? **You choose the meaning.** An added colour does not diagnose your state.

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Free painting – intuition

When we paint freely, with no goal and no effort at a pretty picture, blue often appears at a moment when we need **calm**, space, or when we want to say something and do not know how. Sometimes we know exactly why, sometimes not at all. Both are fine.

What may hide behind a blue stroke

The same blue line on paper can mean something completely different every time, depending on what is happening in us just then. Sometimes it is **calm**, sometimes **longing**, sometimes simply the taste of the colour. That is why there is no point in reading a picture like a test with a single right answer.

Longing for calm and quiet.

Wide horizontal strokes, like a water surface. The colour is spilled out and nothing pushes it onward.

A need to express yourself.

The stroke heads outward, to the edge of the paper, or repeats around something. As if it wanted to say something.

Sadness and longing.

A darker, muted blue, sometimes running or smudged. Low on the paper, like rain.

Loneliness and distance.

A large empty cold area with one small dot in it. Blue keeps people apart.

Perspective and space.

A light, sky blue, at the top of the paper. A feeling that it is possible to breathe.

Depth and mystery.

A dark, rich, midnight blue. Something hides under the surface and does not want to come up yet.

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Blue in a picture. Can it express what is happening inside?

Yes, it can, but it does not have to. When painting you sometimes reach for a colour before you can name what you feel. Blue can then give form to **calm**, a longing for space, but also to **longing** or a feeling that something has stuck in your throat.

It can just as well be simply a pretty colour that you happened to have at hand that day. It gains meaning only in connection with your experience. A colour itself does not know what happened to you. You do, or you will find out in time.

Art therapy also works with the idea that a picture can express something for which words are hard to find. What matters, though, is not one patch of colour but the whole picture and how it came about. Your situation, memories, the movement of your hand and your feelings while painting.

A predominance of blue alone is not enough for a verdict on whether it is **calm** or coldness. Maybe you wanted to rest. Maybe you simply enjoyed that blue so much that no other had a chance that day.

When you want to say something and do not know how

Sometimes you have the words on the tip of your tongue, but they do not yet have a first sentence. **Try** first to paint how you feel the sentence. Wide stripes at the top, a circle that opens, or a single line heading for the edge. It does not have to become a pretty picture. It is enough for the sentence to appear on paper before it appears in your mouth.

Then look at the picture and **try** to write the first word that comes to you. **You do not have to** show it to anyone. A word on paper is often the first step to a sentence that you will one day say aloud.

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When blue takes over the space

First let it come. Maybe you reach for blue and have no idea why. Let it appear on the canvas without any duty to explain whether it is **calm**, **longing** or a memory of the sea. **You can** paint standing, on the floor, with your hand, a brush or a piece of cloth. What matters is what happens to you as you spread the colour, layer it or let it take up more room.

Three things worth noticing

- **QUANTITY**

A drop at the edge, or a whole sea?

A small blue trace can be the centre of the whole picture for you. A large area can feel calm and wide, or start to be too cold. A large blue area is not proof of calm and a small trace does not mean you cannot rest. When you want to, notice. Do I want to dive into it, or do I need more warmth around it?

- **SATURATION**

Icy purity, or a veiled dusk?

A pure cyan is fresh, with white it turns sky blue, with umber smoky. If relief floods you after adding white, it is precisely that change that is interesting. Perhaps a lighter look suits you today. You do not have to draw a conclusion about your whole personality from it.

- **THICKNESS**

What does it feel like under your hands?

Thick paint you can push and leave a trace in. Thin paint spreads, runs and can surprise you with a direction you did not plan. One time the substance and resistance please you, another time the chance to let go of control and watch what happens. It is not a test of courage. Even a careful thin stroke can be exactly your language today.

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What to take from the picture

It does not matter how the blue stroke looks. More important is what you feel while making it, what situation you are in and what is happening in your life. Two almost identical pictures can have a completely different story. One was made after a long day full of people, the other after a week when you needed no one. That is why you will not find a dictionary here, but questions. Life does not fit into one colour table anyway.

What the picture may tell you later

Perhaps after a while you will notice that you kept coming back to blue in a period when you were missing **calm**, space or words for what you feel. Perhaps you will link it with a completely different experience. In self-reflective work inspired by art therapy a picture can serve as a trace of your own experience and a chance to look back. Meaning arises in connection with your memories, not from reading the shade alone.

Answers often do not come right away

Sometimes you look at a picture and it tells you nothing at all. And in a week, a month or a year it suddenly comes: “Aha, this is what I was carrying in myself then.” That is fine. The picture is not running away. **You do not have to** squeeze an answer out of it with a still wet brush.

Neither is wrong and neither is right. **Calm**, **longing**, **perspective** and silence all belong to you and blue can carry everything.

If very strong or **painful** feelings appear while you paint, do not stay with them alone. Talk about them with someone close or with an art therapist or therapist. This page does not replace professional care.

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Associations and stories

Our associations

Associations are the connections that form between us and a colour almost by themselves. We are not born with a ready-made list “blue = this”, and yet some meanings repeat surprisingly often. They are usually made up of three layers. The body, culture and what we have lived through ourselves.

From the body

Blue is the colour of sky and water, that is of what is far away, deep and large. On a clear day it surrounds us from above and we do not have to strain in it. The eye reads it as cool and distant, but also as calm. Blue says. There is room here and no need to hurry.

From culture

Uniforms are blue and banks and hospitals use it. It is the colour of **trust** and **reliability**. At the same time we say we promise someone the blue from the sky when there is no firm basis behind it, and the English *feeling blue* means **sadness**. One colour thus manages both **trust** and **longing**. What we read in it depends also on where we grew up.

From what you have lived

The sea from a holiday, a school or work uniform, a blue raincoat from childhood, a swimming pool, a hospital corridor, jeans you felt good in. These are associations with your own signature. Two women can look at the same sea and one feels freedom, the other **fear** of **depth**. The colour is the same. The story is not.

When you know where your associations come from, it is easier to tell what is blue and what is your story about it.

A question for you

“What does blue connect with first for you?”

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Stories

The blue that cost more than gold

For a long time blue was obtained from the precious stone lapis lazuli, which was mined in the valleys of Badakhshan in present-day Afghanistan. The pigment reached Europe by sea, and that is why it got the name ultramarine, from the Latin *ultramarinus*, "from overseas". In the Renaissance it was among the most prestigious and dearest colours, sometimes valued as highly as gold. Painters therefore often reserved it for the robe of the Virgin Mary.

Artificial ultramarine could be produced only in the 19th century. Jean-Baptiste Guimet developed a process in 1826 but kept it secret, and in 1828 Christian Gmelin published his process. Since then blue has been available even to a painter without a rich patron.

The colour Homer did not write about

The Greek *oînops póntos*, often translated as "wine-dark sea", appears in Homer in both the Iliad and the Odyssey, often with a stormy sea. Blue does not appear in his descriptions of nature. William Gladstone explained this in 1858 by saying that the ancient Greeks described light and dark rather than shades. A similar observation about other old texts was developed in the 1860s by Lazarus Geiger and in 1969 by Brent Berlin and Paul Kay in the study *Basic Color Terms*. According to them languages add words for colours gradually and blue tends to be among the last.

That does not mean the ancient Greeks did not see blue. They just may not have had a separate word for it, and not every theory that grew out of this is taken literally today. What is interesting is that the name of a colour influences how we think about it.

Why the sky is blue

The blue sky is not a dye. Sunlight is scattered in the atmosphere on air molecules and shorter wavelengths (blue) are scattered more than long ones. This is called Rayleigh scattering. We see the sky as blue because blue light reaches us from all directions. At sea it is different. Water absorbs rather the red part of the light and returns blue, so the colour of the sea is also influenced by **depth**, the sky above it and tiny particles in the water.

Blue is, moreover, relatively rare in nature as a pigment. Much blue plumage or many butterfly wings are blue thanks to a structure that bends light, not thanks to a dye. Blue eyes also contain no blue pigment, the colour is created by the scattering of light in the iris.

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Emotions and feelings

The same blue can awaken **calm** in one of us and **longing** in another, sometimes even both in one day.

Blue can awaken in us a slowing down, the wish to talk and also coldness and **distance**. There is no single fixed effect. It depends on our body, experience, culture and situation.

Emotions

Quick and strong reactions that can appear even before you realise them.

Calm

It can bring a feeling that you can **take a breath**. Slowing down, **quiet**, **distance** from the rush. The body lets go.

And why?

Blue is the colour of sky and the surface of water. It forces us to nothing and the eye can stop in it. It is not automatic, though. The same shade can remind one woman that she can breathe out, and another a hospital corridor.

If I asked you now

"Where is your surface on which it feels good to rest?"

Sadness

Heaviness and **melancholy**. But also a soft, **quiet** mood that can be beautiful too.

And why?

In English they say *feeling blue* and the music genre blues is linked with sadness. Blue tends to be the colour of evening, rain and distance. The colour does not cause **sadness**, it rather gives it room so that it is not loud.

Ask yourself

"What am I missing today?"

Loneliness

A feeling that there is distance between me and others. Sometimes a protective **distance**, sometimes a coldness that hurts.

And why?

Blue is a cool colour and we perceive coolness as distance. It can protect, but also separate. **Solitude** that you choose is different from the kind that has happened to you.

Try asking yourself

*"Is my **solitude** chosen, or did it happen to me?"*

Trust

A feeling that someone or something can be relied on. Sobriety, order.

And why?

Uniforms, banks, offices, healthcare. Blue has learned that it seems trustworthy. This **trust** can be pleasant, but also tiring when the same **reliability** is always expected of you.

A question for you

*"Whom **can you** rely on?"*

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Feelings and experience

Less immediate than emotions. They say more about how we feel in a situation, in the body and in relation to ourselves.

Perspective and space

A feeling of **overview**. I see things from a distance and they do not seem so big.

And why?

Sky and sea. Blue invites us to look further than the nearest problem. **Perspective** does not help when you need closeness, so it is good to know both.

Ask yourself

"What would change if I looked at it from a distance?"

Words that want out

The wish to say what is on my mind. A feeling that the words are ready and are only still looking for the first sentence.

And why?

Blue is linked with speaking and expression (in the yogic tradition with the Vishuddha chakra, more about it below). It is calm, in no hurry and listens, and so it is often easier to open up in it. It is not a law, though.

If I asked you now

"What would you like to say that you have not said yet?"

Coldness and distance

A feeling that it is cold around me. Sometimes a pleasant **distance** from people, sometimes a wish to move closer to warmth.

And why?

In painting blue is counted among the cool colours. In the same room one person perceives it as fresh and another woman as a cold waiting room. If a particular blue takes your energy, that is useful information for choosing a colour for your home or a picture.

Try asking yourself

"What would warm this room or this picture?"

Depth and quiet

A feeling that beneath the surface there is something that does not want to come up yet. A **quiet depth**, sometimes mysterious, sometimes heavy.

And why?

A dark, midnight blue resembles night and the deep sea. For some women it gives a feeling of safety, for others heaviness. What decides is how you feel in it.

Ask yourself

"What lies beneath my surface?"

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My blue is not the same as your blue

A colour itself does not experience anything. We experience it. When we first see a colour together with something strong (a smell, a face, a situation, a word), the experience sticks to it. The colour then becomes a shortcut. It is enough to catch sight of it and the body knows whether it can relax or should withdraw. That is why your own reaction matters most.

- **The sea**
  For one freedom and a holiday, for another fear of depth and of not seeing the bottom.
- **A blue uniform**
  For one a feeling of order and trust, for another school, an office or a job she wants to escape from.
- **Hospital blue**
  Relief and care, or fear and waiting for news.

Some colours we put aside. After a hard period we get rid of a dress or avoid a place. It is a way of protecting ourselves. And when we are ready, blue often comes back by itself, first as a piece of sky in the window, then as a scarf.

When to make blue smaller or put it away

You notice you do not want to look at a rich area, a room feels cold to you, or a dark blue feels oppressive. **You do not have to** endure it because of a rule about **calm**. Take off a blue throw, turn the picture round or hide an accessory for a day.

Mental hygiene. A small space without demands

After a day full of screens, replies and other people's needs, when you want to stop reacting for a while. Sit by a window with a view of a piece of sky, or put a blue picture you like in a quiet corner. Put the phone aside. **You do not have to** concentrate on the colour, it is enough that it is there.

A question for you

“Which sentence about blue is loudest in you? Whose is it?”

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Blue in cultures and traditions

Blue is a colour that people for a long time had nothing to make from, and yet today it is given in surveys as the favourite. Every culture reads it in its own way. Sky, protection, **sadness** and divinity. None of these meanings excludes the others. Let us look at a few places and read them well.

This chapter therefore shows two levels. First, how blue is read in different cultures, and then how traditional systems look at it, using it as an image.

Blue in different cultures

Ancient Egypt

Egyptian blue is considered the first artificial pigment. The oldest evidence dates from around 3250 BC. It was made by heating quartz sand, a copper compound, lime and an alkali (natural soda or ash) to roughly 800 to 1000 °C.

The Egyptians linked blue with sky and water. The pigment was used on paintings, statues and small objects. After antiquity the method of production was lost for a long time and modern chemistry reconstructed it only later. A curiosity. Egyptian blue glows in infrared light, and thanks to that its traces can be found even on objects that look uncoloured.

Blue was not a gift of nature, but an invention.

Greece and Turkey

The blue glass amulet nazar (in Turkish *nazar boncuğu*, in Greek *mati*, “eye”) is meant to protect against an **envious** gaze, the so-called evil eye. You find it on houses, in cars and on jewellery.

Belief in the evil eye is very old and widespread around the Mediterranean and the Middle East. The amulet looks back and is meant to turn aside a bad glance. According to folk belief the evil eye is more often ascribed to people with light eyes, who are rarer in these countries.

Blue here means neither **sadness** nor coldness, but protection. The same colour can be a shield, not just a mood colour.

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India

In Hinduism Krishna and Rama, incarnations of the god Vishnu, are often depicted with blue or dark blue skin. Water and the ocean are linked with Vishnu; Shiva too is sometimes depicted in a bluish shade.

It is an iconographic tradition and there is more than one interpretation. Most often blue is read as infinity, sky and ocean. Something that has no boundary and cannot be grasped.

Blue here has no connection with sadness. It means **depth** and the infinite, that is something greater than us.

Japan

In Japan blue is the colour of indigo (in Japanese *ai*), that is the deep, dark blue of fabrics and craft. It is connected with traditional techniques such as *shibori* or *kasuri*.

In the Edo period (1603 to 1868) common people were forbidden to wear silk. Cotton spread and indigo was one of the few dyes with which it could be coloured well. A frugal garment thus became a beautiful, respected tradition.

A restriction can give birth to beauty. A colour that came from necessity became a symbol of simplicity and craft.

Blue in traditional systems

Every tradition looks at blue a little differently, but all take it seriously. It is an old symbolic language and an inspiration, not a healing guide.

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Traditional Chinese medicine

In the Chinese tradition there are five elements. Wood, fire, earth, metal and water. With blue it is more complicated than with other colours. The old Chinese word qing (青) denotes blue and green together and in the list of the five elements belongs to wood. Water in the tradition is linked with black or dark blue, with winter, cold, the salty taste, the kidneys and bladder and the emotion of **fear**. Wisdom and the ability to flow are also grouped with it.

Water is in the Chinese tradition the element of **depth**, **calm** and rest. It is under the surface and waits. When there is enough of it, we are calm, patient and have a reserve. When there is little, the tradition describes exhaustion and **anxiety**. When there is too much, it tends to be a cold closing-off and **fear**.

How it relates to the colour blue. Dark blue is in the tradition the colour of water, that is of **depth**, rest and reserves. Water feeds wood, which is why dark blue is complemented by green. A lighter blue is then read rather as sky and **lightness**.

What you can take from it. Ask yourself whether you have enough water in your life, that is rest and reserves. If not, sleep, warmth, slow eating and **quiet** help. When there is too much water and you are rather withdrawn and fearful, movement, warmth (fire) and small steps outward help.

If I asked you now

"Do you have enough rest in your life?"

Why water, and why is it blue in one place and black in another?

In the basic colour map of the five elements black belongs to water. In some contemporary readings a deep blue to blue-black appears next to it, which is why you find two seemingly different tables. When you read "kidneys" in this teaching, imagine the broader traditional circle of water, the storing of strength and the vital essence jing. It is not a reserve that could be measured. Blue stands here for **the image of deep water**, not for a means that would replenish an organ's energy through clothing or jewellery.

Why winter and rest?

In this tradition winter is the season of water and storing. In the garden you do not expect the same pace of growth in January as in May. Yet you sometimes expect the same performance from yourself every day, even after a demanding week. If you like dark blue, **keep** a blue blanket in the place where you rest and link it with the permission "I do not have to sort anything out now". If it feels cold to you, choose another.

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A personal talisman. A reminder that you do not have to give everything

A blue pebble, pendant or ribbon can connect to the theme of water and storing strength. Choose a single simple meaning: “I do not have to manage everything alone today.” There is no need to ascribe a hidden healing power to the object. Take it on a day when you tend to take on further duties and when you touch it, **allow yourself** to say “I will not take another task today.” If a piece of jewellery presses on you or a scarf irritates you, take it off. Bodily **comfort** is part of support.

Traditional Chinese medicine uses the elements as an image. It is not a diagnosis and does not replace a doctor.

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Ayurveda

Ayurveda is an old Indian teaching about health. In it a person is described by three types of "energy", the so-called doshas. Vata (air, restlessness), pitta (fire, intensity) and kapha (earth and water, heaviness). Colours are chosen to balance what there is too much of. Opposites are treated with opposites. Blue is cooling, calm and **soothing**.

How it relates to the colour blue. For Ayurveda blue is the colour of coolness and **calm**. That is why it is most often recommended where there is too much fire. Sources on colours in Ayurveda differ in detail, so take this as a general direction, not a rule.

Pitta

This is how a woman is described who is purposeful, quick and thorough, and flares up easily. Blue cools and **calms** her. The tradition advises cooling colours, such as blue, green or white.

- **Add blue**
  Light blue in a bedroom or study, a blue scarf, water on the table.
- **Add some cool**
  White and green, swimming, a walk by water.

Vata

This is how a woman is described who is imaginative and quick, but **restless**, who is often cold and sleeps worse. Cool colours may be too cool for vata, but other sources recommend soft light blue shades for **calming**. It is best to notice how you really feel in blue.

- **Warmer shades**
  *A soft sky or dove blue. **Calm** without coldness.*
- **Evening and sleep**
  Soft, muted shades and warm light.

Kapha

This is how a woman is described who is calm, steady and patient, but who easily becomes heavy. Some sources advise limiting cool colours for kapha, because she already has enough **calm** and coolness. Lively, warm colours suit her better.

- **Blue in moderation**
  A light, bright blue suits as an accent, not a dark and heavy one.
- **Add liveliness**
  Red, orange or yellow as a counterweight. A jumper, scarf, tablecloth.

A question for you

"Do you feel calm in blue, or chilled?"

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When you push everything forward. An image of cooling

Some contemporary Ayurvedic approaches recommend blue as a “cooling” colour for fiery pitta. They speak the language of qualities. Hot, sharp, quick against cool and calmer. Colour tables differ; blue is not a universal prescription according to a person's type.

What to imagine by it. You are in a hurry, you want to settle everything at once and by evening you have had enough of further stimuli. **You can** put aside a striking patterned throw and **try** a simple light blue fabric. If it feels more pleasant with it, it can belong to your evening wind-down. You are not treating body temperature this way; you are looking for an impression that does not nudge you to further performance.

When you already feel cold and withdrawn

You do not have to add a “cooling” colour just because a table says so. **Try** blue in a smaller area with a warm cream, a soft texture or natural wood. If you do not feel good in it, leave it for today. The choice can follow your experience, not an effort to meet a typology.

An online test will not reliably determine your dosha. If you are more interested, consult a qualified Ayurvedic practitioner. It is not treatment.

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A Jungian view

Carl Gustav Jung, the Swiss psychiatrist, understood colours as symbols that have two layers. A personal one (what we have experienced with the colour) and one shared by all people (images that repeat across ages and cultures).

In his lectures at the ETH in Zurich he assigned blue to thinking: “Thinking is white or blue, cold as snow.” He was interested in how we think. **Distance**, clarity, a cool head. Elsewhere he wrote that blue means the mental process, reason (nous). Red for him belonged to feeling and green to sensation.

How it relates to the colour blue. Blue can remind you. Stop and look at it with **distance** and a cool head. What do I actually know and what do I only feel?

What you can take from it. When you are **overwhelmed** by feelings, blue in the form of **overview** helps. Write it on paper, say it aloud, look at the sky. When, on the contrary, you live only in your head and analyse everything, red (feeling) or green (body and senses) may do you good.

Try asking yourself

“What do I know today with my head and what do I only feel?”

Jung's ideas about colours are a symbolic framework, not verified science.

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Feng shui

Feng shui is the Chinese art of arranging a space so that it is good to live in. In it blue, and especially dark blue, is the colour of water, the element of **calm**, **depth** and flow. Water belongs to winter and to the direction north. In the map of the house called the bagua, north is linked with career and life path. Blue is therefore usually the colour of **calm** and moving forward.

Blue is like water

> A little refreshes and calms, too much floods you.

In feng shui blue therefore often works best as an accent. A cushion, picture, ceramics or lamp gives a space **calm**. A blue wall, carpet and curtains all at once may feel more like a room where it is cold and company is missing.

Simple tips

- **Want more calm?**
  Add one blue piece in a place where you will see it every day.
- **Want more warmth?**
  Choose grey-blue or sky blue and complement them with wood, linen and warm light.
- **Is it already too much?**
  Add cream, orange, terracotta or more free space.
- **Do you want more voice?**
  Add a blue scarf or a pebble in your pocket and return to them every day.

And above all. Before you repaint a whole room, **try** a throw, a fabric or a larger colour sample. Your feeling is more important than the rules.

Water, or wood?

In some readings dark blue is assigned to water, in others an ordinary blue is linked with wood, that is with growth.

> So the same room can be both “watery” and “wooden”, depending on which school you read.

For your home **you can** take a simple question from this. Do I want to **calm** the space here, or set it flowing? One blue picture and four blue walls are two quite different experiences.

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What people say and what holds true

MYTH Water in a flat always brings money.

TRUTH The tradition speaks of balance, not a guaranteed result. Especially in a bedroom many schools warn against water features.

What blue works well with

- **Cream and linen**
  A softer whole in which blue does not chill.
- **Wood and clay**
  A more earthy, lived-in impression.
- **Orange and terracotta**
  A striking warm and cool contrast; try which will be the main one.
- **Green**
  A natural pair, recalls the sea and the forest. Watch the saturation of both colours.
- **Red**
  A strong contrast. In the language of the five elements water and fire are neighbours as adversaries, but in practice it is a matter of saturation and the size of areas.
- **Grey and white**
  A clean and calm whole. Make sure it is not too cold.

When you say the colours “fight energetically”, **you can** start concretely. Are both too saturated? Are there too many of them? Does their proportion not suit me? Change one thing and **try** spending some time in the room. Not just looking at it from the hall.

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Elements

In feng shui the elements are related to one another.

- **Water feeds wood**
  That is why green and plants suit blue.
- **Metal feeds water**
  White, grey and metal give blue freshness and restraint.
- **Earth holds water back**
  Brown, sand and terracotta ground and warm blue.
- **Water dampens fire**
  Symbolically the opposite of blue is red and orange.

Take it as a traditional picture of the relations between elements, not as a ban on combining two colours in one room. Feng shui has several schools and the recommendations differ.

MYTH Blue is always calm.

TRUTH A dark, cold blue throughout a flat can feel chilly and deadening. **Calm** comes rather from soft shades in balance with warmth.

MYTH The more blue, the more **calm**.

TRUTH When there is too much blue, warmth and closeness are missing. Blue with a companion is better than blue everywhere.

Clothing

Blue in clothing behaves similarly to blue in a flat. Best as a colour that **calms** you and gives you credibility. According to traditional advisers your personal element matters too. Water helps one person, blue is too cold for another. In practice. **Let** your body and the mirror advise you.

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Feng shui room by room

What works – what to watch for – a simple tip.

Living room

What works. Blue cushions, a picture with water or sky. They suit mainly the north part of a room. If your living room is grey and nobody much wants to sit in it, **try** a muted blue throw or two cushions next to a warm cream and wood.

What to watch for. If a dark sofa, a dark wall and blue curtains together feel oppressive, first swap the throw or draw back the curtains; **you do not have to** repaint at once.

A simple tip. Linen, wool and wood make blue softer and warmer. Glossy satin and glass make it cooler. From where does it feel good to look in the room and where does it feel good to sit?

Kitchen and dining room

What works. A blue bowl, mug or tile can be pleasant if you like **freshness**. Wood, linen and ceramics warm blue.

What to watch for. If a whole blue-grey kitchen with white light reminds you of a workplace and you miss **cosiness**, add wood, a warm white or a linen tablecloth. A glossy lacquer and stainless steel cool it.

A simple tip. Try an accessory first, you will see what changes before you start changing cabinets. Blue is not a ban for a kitchen or a guaranteed aid to weight loss. The evidence is weak and it depends on shade and light.

Bedroom

What works. Soft, muted shades (sky blue, grey-blue) help **calming**. Cotton and linen in blue-grey are pleasant to touch and when falling asleep.

What to watch for. A rich dark blue can be too cold; balance it with warm textiles. A large dark area behind the bed can feel like pressure. A stormy sea can be a beautiful picture, but if it arouses **tension** in you, put it elsewhere.

A simple tip. You need neither a fountain nor a blue night lamp. An object or picture that reminds you of **calm** is enough. What do you see just before you fall asleep and how does it feel to look at it?

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Children's room

What works. Lighter blue shades feel calm; a blue carpet, cushion or blanket is soft and movable.

What to watch for. Watch out for coldness. Add warm accessories and wood.

A simple tip. Let the child choose where their blue thing will stand. The child can feel it and decide for themselves.

Study

What works. Light blue helps concentration and **calm**, especially in combination with natural materials. A smaller blue area, the cover of a diary or a picture can belong to your focused time.

What to watch for. A rich electric blue on a large wall can disturb. **Try** a more muted shade or leave it only on an accessory. A glossy blue surface in the field of view can reflect into the eyes.

A simple tip. Blue helps here as a signal. When you finish in the evening, close the diary and put the work things away. It will not save a deadline, though. From where is it pleasant for you to see into the room?

Bathroom

What works. Water belongs here naturally. Turquoise and light blue feel fresh; blue towels or a small area of tiles carry an impression of cleanliness and water.

What to watch for. If you already have cold flooring, little daylight and glossy surfaces, another dark blue can strengthen the feeling of cold.

A simple tip. Balance it with a soft towel in a sandy tone, warmer light and fewer things on display. How does it feel to look at yourself in the mirror and what is reflected in it?

How to find your measure of blue

For a few days put a blue fabric or picture in the room. **Notice** in the morning and in the evening. Do I want to be here? Does the room feel cosy, open or cold to me? Then put the object aside for a while. **You do not have to** make a table or rate your feelings. In a shared flat leave room for the person who experiences the same colour differently.

Ask yourself

“Where in the flat does blue do me good and where does it chill me?”

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Colour frequency and phototherapy

Blue light has real biological uses, and so it is good to separate what is science, what atmosphere and what already wishful thinking. It depends on the spectrum, amount, place and length of exposure. A blue shirt, a phone and a therapeutic lamp are not the same thing.

And it is exactly here that it is good to put miraculous promises aside. A blue lamp is not magic for mood, hormones or chakras.

Where blue light is really used

Newborn jaundice. Why they shine light on a baby

Special blue to blue-green light changes bilirubin in the skin into forms that the body can excrete more easily. Devices for this care use roughly the band of 460 to 490 nanometres. A paediatrician decides according to measured values, age and the child's condition; they monitor effectiveness and protection during treatment. An ordinary blue bulb is not enough for this and trying it at home is not recommended.

Dermatology. Light together with a medicinal substance

For some sun-damaged skin lesions, for example actinic keratoses, photodynamic therapy is used. A doctor applies a light-sensitive substance and then uses a suitable source, sometimes blue, sometimes red. The light activates the substance. Instructions for protecting the skin afterwards are part of it. The skin is thus not treated by an ordinary blue lamp, but by the whole procedure under a doctor's supervision.

And what about blue acne masks?

Blue light is studied and used for acne in some devices, but the results cannot be transferred to every mask. A 2024 American dermatological guideline states that for lasers and light-based devices there is so far too little supporting evidence for it to recommend them. With scarring or persistent problems discuss care with a dermatologist.

Eyes and brain. Why evening light matters

Besides seeing, the eyes help the body know when it is day. They have light-sensitive cells with the pigment melanopsin, most sensitive at roughly 480 nm, that is to the blue-turquoise part of light. They send a signal to our internal clock. Such light can support alertness and in the evening dampen the production of melatonin. Bright evening lighting and screens can therefore make falling asleep harder.

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Blue light is not automatically the enemy of the eyes

Ordinary screens are not a proven cause of eye damage from blue light. Difficulties during long work also have other connections. Close-up viewing, glare and less blinking. Take breaks, adjust the brightness and deal with persistent problems with an eye specialist.

Blue-light glasses

Glasses that filter blue light are often offered, promising better sleep or less strained eyes. A 2023 Cochrane review that summarised 17 randomised studies, however, concluded that the evidence is ambiguous. For eye strain from a computer apparently no short-term benefit, for sleep an unclear effect. The studies did not assess long-term effects on the retina.

Seasonal depression

For some difficulties light treatment is really used, for example bright white light for seasonal depression. The choice of procedure follows the particular problem, not a favourite colour, and belongs in the hands of a doctor.

For the curious. What is the frequency of light

A photon is a packet of light energy and frequency describes the oscillation of light. These numbers help describe a device; they do not determine what is missing in your life or whether you need blue jewellery.

Is it treatment by blue?

In colour and spiritual approaches blue light can be part of relaxation or visualisation. That is a different purpose from medical phototherapy. For the claim that an ordinary blue lamp heals the throat chakra, sleep disorders or depression we do not have sufficient basis.

What to expect from blue light and what is too much

- **What you can expect**
  A blue evening atmosphere can be a pleasant part of the day.
- **What is too much**
  That one blue lamp will improve sleep, open the throat chakra, cure acne like a treatment in a clinic or replace a doctor with a long-term worsened mood.

This is not about the symbolism of blue, but about honest limits of what light can do.

If I asked you now

“Are you getting enough daylight?”

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Astrotype and colours

Are you Pisces, Libra, Sagittarius, or another sign? Astrological type is a much broader topic than just the sun sign. If you want to go really into **depth**, knowing only the date of birth is not enough. The exact place and time of birth matter too, because only from them are the ascendant, the position of the Moon, the planets and other parts of the horoscope calculated. Here, though, we really keep only to the edge of what relates to colours.

The ascendant is the sign that was rising on the eastern horizon at the moment of your birth. According to astrological tradition it shows how you come across outwardly and how you enter the world, while the Sun sign describes more who you are inside. For each sign you will therefore find not only its character but also a short note on how the colour fits when it is your ascendant.

Aries (21 March – 19 April)

Your blue

denim blue · royal · cobalt

A blue that **calms** you when the pace sets you off running.

Aries is linked in astrology with Mars, fire and the start of spring. It is quick and direct. Blue is for it a brake with reason. It gives you **perspective** without taking away **courage**.

What Aries is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality cardinal · ruler Mars

Aries opens the zodiac and you can tell that it is first. It is a **pioneer** who gets into things before thinking them through perfectly. It is direct, impatient and likes to compete. It gets angry quickly but forgives quickly too.

Its strength is the **courage** to begin. Weaker is perseverance in long, slow matters. It does best where something is happening and where it can act at once.

What it can support in you

Blue can support moments when you want to wait before setting off. It suits places where your energy is quicker than your plan.

With Aries, strength is in decision. A calm blue can add consideration.

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Shadow suppressed vehemence

In the shadow Aries keeps its energy under a lid. Instead of calm, tension arises that is later released violently.

Aries does not like delays. Blue may seem too slow and cold to you.

And when you take it too seriously, you start keeping quiet and quietly piling up displeasure instead of saying it.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you slow down and **think over** a step before you take it.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

When blue seems too little alive to you, add Mars red as an accent. When there is too much of it, it helps.

- Mars red as an accent
- cream
- orange

Cream and orange add warmth without taking away your **calm**.

Aries as ascendant

When Aries is your ascendant, you come across as direct, lively and decisive. People may see you as someone who gets straight to the point, and the first impression tends to be brisk.

Blue calms your impression and adds credibility, but does not take away your courage.

In everyday life

*Keep blue for moments when you need to **take a breath** before saying something.*

*When you set off too fast, **try** sky blue. It will remind you that the pace can be slowed even with enthusiasm.*

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Taurus (20 April – 20 May)

Your blue

light sky blue · denim · smoky

Sky above a field. **Calm** you can feel with your hands.

Taurus is an earth sign linked with Venus, the senses and stability. According to one source (digitalambler) blue also belongs to Venus. A light blue gives it **lightness**, for example the sky above a field.

What Taurus is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality fixed · ruler Venus

Taurus is an earthy, **patient** and sensual sign. It likes good food, pleasant materials, nature and security. It gets going slowly, but once it decides on something, it persists.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to enjoy the present moment. The weaker side tends to be stubbornness and finding it hard to let go of what is familiar.

What it can support in you

Blue can support **calm** in the body and a feeling that there is nowhere to hurry.

With Taurus it is often not only about the colour but about the material. Blue on a linen tablecloth or ceramics feels completely different from glossy plastic.

Shadow silence and withdrawal

In the shadow Taurus keeps silent and endures quietly. Calm turns into passivity and it does not say what it needs.

Taurus needs tangibility. A cold blue may seem aloof to you if the warmth of a material is missing.

And when you have got used to it, you do not want to let go of anything you know. A cold, **quiet** colour can strengthen the feeling that nothing is moving.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **calm** the mind and support a feeling of stability.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Venus green or pink and something soft.

Venus green · pink · cream · wood

They add more warmth and sensuality.

Taurus as ascendant

When Taurus is your ascendant, you come across as calm, stable and pleasant. You build trust slowly and people often feel firm ground in you.

Denim or navy blue suit it and strengthen trust.

In everyday life

*Blue can remind you that **calm** is not laziness.*

***You can** treat yourself to something good without having to excuse it.*

Gemini (21 May – 20 June)

Your blue

sky · cornflower · icy

The blue of thoughts and words.

Gemini is linked with Mercury, movement and curiosity. According to one source (digitalambler) blue is also among Mercury's colours. It suits your thinking and words.

What Gemini is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Gemini is **curious**, talkative and adaptable. It learns quickly, likes to tell stories and enjoys it when a lot is going on around it. It can see several sides of one thing.

Its strength is **lightness** and wit. The weaker side tends to be scatteredness and a tendency to start more things than can be finished.

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What it can support in you

Blue can support the wish to talk, write and ask.

When you are bored, its **freshness** can wake you. And Gemini really cannot stay bored for long.

Shadow words without feelings

In the shadow Gemini talks and explains, but does not say what it feels. There are many words and little closeness.

Gemini gets bored quickly. Too much blue may flood you with thoughts and too little action.

Too many ideas and words at once can end in an unfinished diary and five half-read books.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **express yourself** clearly and arrange your thoughts.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Mercury orange brings a spark and the body.

Mercury orange · yellow · white

Orange and yellow help you carry thoughts into action.

Gemini as ascendant

When Gemini is your ascendant, you come across as lively, friendly and chatty. People may see you as curious and youthful, even if inside you are perhaps calmer.

Light blue or turquoise catch their lightness and give clear words.

In everyday life

Put blue where clarity and conversation suit. A notebook, pen, mug.

For days when your head is racing, choose a more muted shade and leave just one blue detail.

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Cancer (21 June – 22 July)

Your blue

sea · smoky · icy

Blue like water that surrounds you.

Cancer is linked with the Moon, water and the start of summer. It is caring and sensitive. Blue is for it water that will protect it.

What Cancer is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality cardinal · ruler Moon

Cancer is **caring**, sensitive and strongly connected to home and family. It has a good memory for feelings and relationships. It enters the world cautiously, much like a crab with its shell.

Its strength is **empathy** and the ability to create safety. The weaker side tends to be changeable moods and a tendency to withdraw when it feels hurt.

What it can support in you

Blue can support a feeling of home, the wish to care and to be close.

With Cancer it is important that the colour is soft. Blue suits it in a blanket, a cushion and in evening light.

Shadow sadness and longing

In the shadow Cancer plunges into melancholy. Deep water becomes heavy and it closes itself in it.

Cancer is vulnerable. A dark blue can strengthen **sadness**.

And when you already look after everyone, another cold colour can remind you that you yourself are left outside.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you calm emotions and have a feeling of **safety**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Moon white and silver bring back the light.

Moon white · silver · apricot

They add dawn so that the water is not only deep.

Cancer as ascendant

When Cancer is your ascendant, you come across as gentle and careful. At first you keep your distance, but then warmth unfolds and people see in you someone who will look after them.

A smoky or sea blue adds calm, a dark one would seem too sad.

In everyday life

Blue in a soft fabric and in evening light is safest for you.

***Give yourself** something warming just for yourself, not only for others.*

Leo (23 July – 22 August)

Your blue

royal blue · cobalt · navy

Royal blue with a drop of gold.

Leo is linked with the Sun, fire and the peak of summer. It wants to shine. Royal blue with a drop of gold is dignified.

What Leo is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality fixed · ruler Sun

Leo is **generous**, proud and creative. It likes to give, likes to rejoice and needs others to see and appreciate it. It is loyal and has a big heart.

Its strength is **warmth** and the ability to inspire others. The weaker side tends to be sensitivity to criticism and a tendency to want to be the centre of attention.

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What it can support in you

Blue can support **confidence** with **calm**. **You do not have to** raise your voice to be heard.

Leo wants to shine. A rich royal blue gives it ground for that.

Shadow calm as a mask

In the shadow Leo appears dignified and calm so as not to show how much it hurts that nobody saw it.

Leo does not want to go unnoticed. A cold blue alone may seem not radiant enough to you.

And when you want everyone to see you, it can tire you that everyone sees you.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you choose **calm** and dignity instead of showing off.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Sun gold and yellow hold the Sun.

Sun gold · yellow · dark red

Gold above blue is a classic. Dignified and bright.

Leo as ascendant

When Leo is your ascendant, you come across as self-assured, warm and striking. You enter a room in a way that people notice you even when you do not want them to.

Royal blue is dignified, it adds elegance and calm.

In everyday life

*Blue suits moments when something has gone well for you and **you do not have to** prove it.*

*When it turns into a uniform, **try** swapping it for a warmer one for a day.*

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Virgo (23 August – 22 September)

Your blue

smoky blue · sky · denim

A blue that gives clarity and focus.

Virgo is linked with Mercury, earth and the end of summer. According to the same source (digitalambler) blue belongs to Mercury. Virgo loves order and clarity.

What Virgo is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality mutable · ruler Mercury

Virgo is **meticulous**, attentive and practical. It notices details that others overlook and likes to be useful. It tends to be modest and judges itself more strictly than others.

Its strength is **reliability** and the ability to improve things. The weaker side tends to be perfectionism, worries and a tendency to criticise itself.

What it can support in you

Blue can support concentration and calm precision.

It works well in a small dose. The cover of a diary, one blue folder, a pen.

Shadow cold strictness

In the shadow Virgo judges coldly, above all herself. Reason overrides feeling and relationships cool.

Virgo is critical, above all of itself. A very cold blue can strengthen the criticism.

And when you are strict with yourself, even a calm colour can start to serve as another item on a list.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **relax** the mind and see clearly what is essential.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

White or a warm apricot will bring kindness.

White · apricot · soft green

Clean areas and warmth soften the inner proofreader.

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Virgo as ascendant

When Virgo is your ascendant, you come across as neat, restrained and reliable. People see you as observant and sensible, sometimes even overly reserved.

Blue-grey or denim adds clarity and credibility.

In everyday life

Blue can remind you that done does not have to be perfect.

***Try** it on things that do not have to be useful.*

Libra (23 September – 22 October)

Your blue

sky · lavender · smoky

The blue of balance and **calm**.

Libra is linked with Venus, air and the start of autumn. It seeks balance and beauty. According to one source blue is the colour of Venus and brings balance and **calm**.

What Libra is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality cardinal · ruler Venus

Libra longs for **harmony**, beauty and justice. It is diplomatic, sociable and has a feel for aesthetics. It lives best in relationships in which it does not feel alone.

Its strength is **tact** and the ability to see both sides. The weaker side tends to be hesitation and a tendency to avoid conflict even when it would help.

What it can support in you

Blue can give a balanced **calm**. Next to cream or a light green it becomes an elegant accessory.

Libra has a feeling for proportions. It recognises how much blue still decorates.

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Shadow silence for the sake of peace

In the shadow Libra keeps quiet rather than disturb the peace. The truth stays unspoken and tension grows.

Libra finds it hard to decide. Blue alone may seem cold to you.

When you are unsure of a shade of blue, choose the one that **calms** you, not the one that seems most correct.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **balance** relationships and give a conversation calm.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Venus green, pink or apricot hold warmth.

Pink · Venus green · apricot

Soft colours around it leave it charm without coldness.

Libra as ascendant

When Libra is your ascendant, you come across as elegant, pleasant and balanced. People like you for your tact, even if inside you take a long time to decide.

Light blue and sky blue suit them and support harmony.

In everyday life

Choose one shade and live with it for a week. A decision is sometimes born from using it.

Put blue where you will look at beauty. A vase, tablecloth, scarf.

Scorpio (23 October – 21 November)

Your blue

midnight · ink · navy

A deep dark blue, mysterious and safe.

Scorpio is according to tradition linked with Mars, water and autumn. It likes **depth** and intensity, and so a deep dark blue suits it.

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What Scorpio is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality fixed · ruler Mars, in the newer view also Pluto

Scorpio is **intense**, deep and loyal. It feels strongly, but does not always show it. It dislikes superficiality and likes to get to what is hidden.

Its strength is **determination** and the ability to transform. The weaker side tends to be distrust, jealousy and a need to keep things under control.

What it can support in you

Blue can support inner **depth** without an outer show.

With Scorpio it is about the feeling that the colour knows something and does not need to talk about it.

Shadow deep silence

In the shadow Scorpio goes quiet and withdraws. Its own depth turns into a wall behind which nobody can see.

Scorpio cannot bear superficiality. A light blue may seem superficial to you.

And a deep colour easily turns dark when something is troubling you. **Try** then not to add another heavy layer.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you calm inner tension and find **quiet**.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Mars dark red suits midnight blue. When you need light.

- Mars dark red
- cream
- gold

Cream and gold let air into the **depth**.

Scorpio as ascendant

When Scorpio is your ascendant, you come across as focused, mysterious and strong. People sense the intensity of your gaze and often feel that you know more than you say.

A dark blue and ink add depth, but beware of closing off.

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In everyday life

Blue suits in a deep, quiet form. Ink, wool, evening light.

***Treat yourself** to one cheerful thing that does not have to be deep.*

Sagittarius (22 November – 21 December)

Your blue

Jupiter blue · sky · turquoise

The blue of sky, roads and freedom.

Sagittarius is linked with Jupiter, fire and late autumn. According to the astrological tradition blue belongs to Jupiter. It is the colour of sky and roads. It loves freedom.

What Sagittarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element fire · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter

Sagittarius is **optimistic**, open and free-spirited. It loves travel, new experiences and the search for meaning. It speaks honestly, sometimes a little too directly.

Its strength is **enthusiasm** and faith in a good outcome. The weaker side tends to be impatience with detail and a tendency to promise more than can be managed.

What it can support in you

Blue can support the wish to set off and look further.

Sagittarius will carry it on a scarf, a rucksack or a map.

Shadow perspective without closeness

In the shadow Sagittarius uses perspective to keep distance. It sees things from above and stops being among people.

Sagittarius cannot bear restriction. A cold blue may seem restrictive to you if there is no movement in it.

And **optimism** can turn into “it will somehow work out”.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you give your ideas direction and **perspective**.

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Counterbalance what to balance it with

Jupiter green and a little warmth.

Jupiter green · orange · white

Green and orange add a horizon with fire.

Sagittarius as ascendant

When Sagittarius is your ascendant, you come across as open, jovial and adventurous. People see you as someone with a wide outlook and an appetite for discovery.

Blue like sky and ocean underlines its freedom.

In everyday life

Blue can remind you that the journey is at home too.

Sit for a while at sunset and do not think about the next destination.

Capricorn (22 December – 19 January)

Your blue

dark blue · midnight · denim

A dark blue that gives seriousness and support.

Capricorn is linked with Saturn, earth and winter. It is practical and persevering. A dark blue gives it seriousness and support.

What Capricorn is like according to astrological tradition

Element earth · quality cardinal · ruler Saturn

Capricorn is **responsible**, goal-oriented and disciplined. It likes to build and is not afraid of a long road. It has a dry sense of humour and shows it only to those it trusts.

Its strength is **perseverance** and the ability to see things through. The weaker side tends to be strictness with itself, reserve and a tendency to put joy off until later.

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What it can support in you

Blue can support a feeling of stability in the middle of deadlines and duties.

It wears it well on materials that last. Wool, leather, quality cotton.

Shadow coldness and distance

In the shadow Capricorn cools. Discipline covers feelings and those around feel the distance.

Capricorn is strict with itself. A very cold blue can strengthen strictness.

And when you endure for a long time, **you may** forget that warmth belongs to you too.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you create **calm** and a clear structure.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Something just for **pleasure**.

Cream · orange · brown

Soft materials and a warm colour that does not have to achieve anything.

Capricorn as ascendant

When Capricorn is your ascendant, you come across as serious, mature and reserved. People may see you as older than you are, and only later discover how funny you are.

Navy blue adds dignity, but add a warmer tone to it as well.

In everyday life

Take blue into the working day, as support.

***Treat yourself** to something with no purpose and no result.*

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Aquarius (20 January – 18 February)

Your blue

electric · sky · icy

The blue of air, **distance** and independence.

Aquarius is according to tradition linked with Saturn, air and winter. It likes **distance** and independence. Blue is the colour of air and **perspective**.

What Aquarius is like according to astrological tradition

Element air · quality fixed · ruler Saturn, in the newer view also Uranus

Aquarius is **independent**, original and idealistic. It is interested in ideas, humanity and the future. It wants to go its own way and does not like adapting to expectations.

Its strength is **perspective** and the ability to come up with new things. The weaker side tends to be distance from feelings and a tendency to withdraw when there is too much closeness.

What it can support in you

Blue can support originality and **distance**. One blue piece in an otherwise calm wardrobe.

It suits where you do not want to blend in.

Shadow aloofness

In the shadow Aquarius speaks about ideas and about people only in general terms. Closeness is unpleasant for it.

Aquarius does not like predictability. An ordinary blue may seem boring to you.

And if the colour starts to carry you into the role of “the one above it all”, your own closeness may slip away from you.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **convey** your ideas clearly.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

One unexpected colour accent.

orange · pink · yellow

A warm counterpart underlines that blue is your choice, not a shield.

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Aquarius as ascendant

When Aquarius is your ascendant, you come across as independent, a little unusual and friendly. People see you as an original personality who keeps their own space.

An electric or turquoise blue underlines originality.

In everyday life

Blue on a single object (a lamp, socks, an envelope) works better than a whole outfit.

***Try** it in a place where nobody expects it.*

Pisces (19 February – 20 March)

Your blue

sky · sea · lavender

The blue of dreams, water and delicacy.

Pisces is according to tradition linked with Jupiter, water and the end of winter. It loves dreams and delicacy. Blue is the colour of Jupiter and also of water and dreaming.

What Pisces is like according to astrological tradition

Element water · quality mutable · ruler Jupiter, in the newer view also Neptune

Pisces is **empathic**, intuitive and dreamy. It picks up the moods around it and often has a rich imagination. It frequently has a bond with art, music and spirituality.

Its strength is **compassion** and creative fantasy. The weaker side tends to be merging with other people's feelings, escaping into dreams and difficulty setting boundaries.

What it can support in you

Blue can support dreaming and quiet comfort.

It is best carried by soft, bleeding surfaces.

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Shadow merging with a sad mood

In the shadow Pisces merges with the heaviness around it. Depth turns into an inner burden.

Pisces easily dissolves. A very dark blue may pull you into sadness.

And when you escape into dreaming, another cold colour will not help you back into the world.

The colour can help you here too. It helps you **calm** sensitivity and find support.

Counterbalance what to balance it with

Jupiter green, soft shades of water and warmth.

Jupiter green · apricot · cream

Green and apricot calm and anchor.

Pisces as ascendant

When Pisces is your ascendant, you come across as gentle, dreamy and adaptable. People like to project their wishes onto you and tend to be kind to you.

A pastel and sea blue add depth and calm.

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In everyday life

Blue can remind you that gentleness is strength.

When the day dissolves for you, do one small thing with your hands.

FOR A DEEPER LOOK

- **Seasons**

Blue is the colour of the summer sky and the sea, but also of a winter dusk. Pisces belongs to the end of winter, Cancer to summer. Ask yourself when you reach for blue.

- **Time of day**

Blue is the colour of day and of dusk. In the morning it refreshes, in the evening it calms, late at night it can be too cold.

- **Years of life**

Saturn returns to the place where it was at your birth at roughly 27 to 31 years and again between 56 and 60. Astrology reads this as a time of reassessment and a new order. In these years blue may feel close to you, or on the contrary foreign. Both are natural.

A question for you

“When do you like blue best. Morning, evening, summer, winter?”

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Colour for your website and business

Yes, and that is precisely its trap. It is the safest choice, and so it is easy to get lost in it.

Blue is a colour that people trust because they see it everywhere. In banks, in technology, in hospitals and in offices. In a 2015 YouGov survey blue was the favourite colour in ten countries on four continents (23 to 33% of respondents). That is why it is often the first choice in business. This part is not a guide to what you must do. It is an aid to know what blue promises and how not to get lost among other brands.

By itself, though, it **does not attract customers** like a magnet. It can help evoke **trust** and **calm**, but what mainly decides is still **what you sell**, **to whom** and **how well** it all works together.

What we are telling the customer

Blue can say, for example

"You can rely on us." "We speak clearly." "We are in no hurry." "It is calm here."

- **Trust and reliability.** Blue does not sound loud. It sounds sure. That is why brands where the customer entrusts money, data or health use it.
- **Competence.** A 2012 study (Labrecque and Milne) suggested that people more often perceive brands in blue as competent and in red as exciting. It is one study, not a law.
- **Calm and space.** It suits where you want to slow the pace and let the customer think.
- **Distance.** A cold blue can seem aloof, formal or corporate.

Depending on the shade, though, it can also act differently. A dark navy feels **sure and prestigious**, sky blue **open and calm**, turquoise **fresh and creative**, an electric blue **more striking and technological**.

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Simple tips

Shade by role

A dark navy for certainty and prestige, a light sky blue for openness and calm, turquoise for freshness and creativity.

A warm accent

Add a warm colour to blue (orange, coral, yellow) so that the brand does not seem like a bank. Orange is its opposite on the colour wheel, which is why they stand out together.

Legibility

For ordinary text a contrast of at least 4.5 to 1 is recommended (the WCAG accessibility rule). Dark blue text on white works well, light blue on white does not. Check the contrast before you put the colour on text or a button.

Cultural context

In Turkey and Greece blue protects, in India it is infinity, in England sadness. Before you set off into the world, find out what blue means for you and for them.

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Professions where it is a Yes

Consulting, education, voice and word

Blue suits professions that stand on speaking, writing and listening. Trainers, speakers, journalists, podcasters, translators, therapists. It can recall calm and clarity. Try a darker blue as the base and a warm accent for a personal tone. If a website is entirely in electric blue, it can seem more technological than human.

Finance, law and technology

Here blue is almost expected. Why. The customer wants reliability and clarity from you and blue is visually learned for them. The biggest risk is that you get lost among the others. A different shade from the competition, your own typeface or one unusual accent will help.

Healthcare and care

A light blue and blue-green can evoke cleanliness and calm. For some, though, also a hospital corridor and waiting for news. Ask customers what blue reminds them of before you give it a large area.

Water, travel and rest

Blue naturally connects to the sea, rivers, pools and the sky. It suits spas, swimming, accommodation, travel or services around sleep and rest. It helps promise calm and space. Just do not let it seem cold. Add wood, cream or a warm detail so that the guest sees that someone cares for them.

Professions where it is a No

This is not a ban for whole fields. What decides is the interplay of colour, text, photographs and setting.

- **Hospitality and celebrations.** A cold blue can seem aloof where you want to invite people closer. A warm accessory, wood or photographs of people soften the tone.
- **Playful children's goods.** A light blue is pleasant, but whole rich areas can seem stark. Add playful colours.

Give important information clearly legible dark text.

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Before you send it out into the world

Show the design to a woman who does not know your offer and ask “What would you expect from such a place or service?” **Is the offer visible, or mainly the blue?** Her answer may tell you more than the general rule that blue means trust.

A question for you

“What should your customer feel first when she looks at your website?”

Examples from the market

You know blue from banks, apps and boxes. Here are **a few examples** that show what it can do.

- **Facebook (social network)**
  According to a 2010 article in The New Yorker, Mark Zuckerberg is red-green colour blind and said of blue (loosely translated) “Blue is the richest colour for me. I can see all of blue.” It is a story about why the colour was chosen, not proof that blue sells.
- **Tiffany (jewellery)**
  A light blue (turquoise blue) appeared on the cover of the Blue Book catalogue in 1845. Pantone produces it as a special colour with the number 1837, after the year the company was founded, and the company has had it as a trademark since 1998. The colour carries prestige here, not coldness.
- **Nivea (cosmetics)**
  In 1925 Nivea received new packaging, the blue tin with a white logo that we know to this day. Blue carries purity and trust here.
- **Ford (cars)**
  The blue oval first appeared on Ford cars in 1927, among others on the Model A. The blue background with white lettering was more striking than the earlier white emblem.

What they share is that blue carries a simple message. **Trust, certainty, calm**. And brands hold it for a long time and consistently. Success is not made by the colour itself, but by there being something behind it that people believe in.

Colours in business are not law. Studies are mixed and a lot depends on context, on customers and on how consistent the brand is. Take it as an idea to test, not as a rule. The brand examples are publicly known and the facts about them come from public sources.

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Different colour combinations

Blue + red

How it feels

Spark and calm at the same time. Blue calms, red warms; together they are a strong contrast.

When it suits

When you want strength with composure.

Specific shades



blue + red
strikingly



navy + crimson
seriously and warmly



sky + scarlet
freshly



denim + brick
earthily



midnight + wine
deeply

In practice

Red lipstick and a blue coat. A red cushion on a blue sofa.

Watch out

Large areas of both look like a flag and tire the eyes.

Blue + orange

How it feels

Joy and grounding. Orange is the opposite of blue on the colour wheel. The strongest contrast of warm and cool.

When it suits

When you want blue to warm up.

Specific shades



blue + orange
strikingly



denim + terracotta
earthily and calmly



sky + apricot
gently



navy + pumpkin
autumnally



petrol + tangerine
playfully

In practice

An orange shawl with a blue jumper. An orange candle in a blue room.

Watch out

Mixed together they turn brown. Side by side both can amplify each other, give one the main role.

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Blue + yellow

How it feels

Lightness and optimism. Blue gives calm and yellow shines; side by side they brighten like the sun in the sky.

When it suits

When you want an optimistic, summery impression.

Specific shades


blue + lemon
sunnily


navy + mustard
autumnally


sky + buttery
softly


cobalt + amber
festively


denim + ochre
earthily

In practice

A yellow accessory in a blue room. Yellow flowers in a blue vase.

Watch out

A rich yellow with a dark blue can feel loud, sometimes like the brand of a department store.

Blue + green

How it feels

Deep calm and freshness. The other neighbour of blue. A feeling of sea and forest at once.

When it suits

When you want natural calm.

Specific shades


blue + green
naturally


petrol + sage
gently and earthily


navy + dark green
richly


sky + mint
freshly


denim + moss
woodland-like

In practice

Turquoise in a bathroom. A blue dress and a green scarf. Sea shades in a bedroom.

Watch out

When there is too much of both and warmth is missing, the mood can be cold and quiet.

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Blue + indigo

How it feels

Deep inward. A calm, quiet depth. Blue next to indigo gets the silence of the sky at dusk.

When it suits

When you want intuition and depth.

Specific shades


blue + indigo
deeply


sky + ink
dramatically


denim + midnight
at evening


smoky + plum blue
muted


cobalt + navy
richly

In practice

Blue and indigo in a bedroom. Evening lighting.

Watch out

When there is too much indigo, the mood tends to be heavy and pensive.

Blue + violet

How it feels

Something magical and playful. A sense of mystery in a calm setting, like lavender and bluebells.

When it suits

When you want mystery and a gentle romance.

Specific shades


blue + magenta
boldly


sky + lavender
tenderly


navy + plum
deeply


cobalt + amethyst
playfully


smoky + lilac
gently

In practice

A purple shawl with a blue coat. Lavender and blue sky.

Watch out

Too much purple can feel dramatic.

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Blue + pink

How it feels

Tenderness and calm. Blue gives distance, pink kindness.

When it suits

When you want tenderness without sweetness.

Specific shades



smoky + powder
tenderly



sky + pale pink
playfully



denim + old rose
earthily and gently



navy + fuchsia
boldly



petrol + salmon
warmly

In practice

Powder pink and blue-grey in a bedroom. A pink blanket on a blue sofa.

Watch out

Take care that it is not too sweet; add cream or wood.

Blue + grey

How it feels

Distance and calm. Grey mutes blue and blue enlivens grey. A blue-grey arises, elegant and calm.

When it suits

When you want a restrained, modern look.

Specific shades



blue + anthracite
modernly



smoky + light grey
calmly



sky + dove
gently



navy + slate
elegantly



denim + silver-grey
quietly

In practice

A blue-grey wall. A grey dress and a blue scarf.

Watch out

Too much blue-grey can feel dull and sad.

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Blue + brown

How it feels

Support and naturalness. Brown and blue are a natural pair. Sand and sea, jeans and leather, wood and sky.

When it suits

When you want grounding and natural materials.

Specific shades


denim + chocolate
richly


sky + caramel
softly


navy + dark wood
earthily


blue + chestnut
autumnally


smoky + beige
gently

In practice

Wooden furniture and blue textiles. Jeans and brown shoes.

Watch out

Two earthy colours can be heavy; add a light cream.

Blue + white

How it feels

Freshness and clarity. White gives blue space and purity; blue stands out next to it like the sea with foam or the sky with clouds.

When it suits

When you want lightness and space.

Specific shades


blue + pure white
freshly


navy + cream
softly


sky + milk
quietly


denim + ivory
naturally


cobalt + linen
calmly

In practice

A white kitchen with blue accessories. A white shirt and blue trousers.

Watch out

Too much blue and white can be sterile; cream is gentler.

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Blue + black

How it feels

Depth and elegance. Black raises contrast; blue next to it looks dark and elegant, like night or ink.

When it suits

When you want a deep, festive mood.

Specific shades



blue + black
strikingly



navy + charcoal
elegantly



sky + graphite
gently



cobalt + anthracite
richly



midnight + black
darkly

In practice

A black dress and a blue scarf. Black furniture with a blue detail.

Watch out

When there is too much, it can feel heavy.

Blue + gold

How it feels

Night and light. Blue cools gold and gold makes blue glow. Together they feel calm and noble.

When it suits

When you want **calm and depth**.

Specific shades



blue + gold
calmly



dark blue + antique gold
nobly



sky + champagne
deeply



cobalt + deep gold
freshly



denim + matt gold
soberly

In practice

A dark blue dress and gold jewellery. A blue wall and a gold frame.

Watch out

Both tend to be strong. Without a warm companion the whole can feel **cold**.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to warm blue, add orange, terracotta, cream or wood.
- When you want to ground it, add brown, beige or natural materials.
- When you want to soften it, add white, grey or pink.
- When you want to deepen it, indigo, midnight blue or black will help.

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